

Material Exploration

Leather & Fabric

STRIKEFLY

Student

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Faculty

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Duration

10 Days

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INTRODUCTION

This project focuses on creating a product that incorporates leather as the primary material, emphasising the exploration of various leather crafting techniques such as stitching, embossing, and appliqué. It aims to develop a deep understanding of different types of leather, their textures, finishes, and durability, while combining functionality with aesthetic appeal. The project highlights artisanal craftsmanship, showcasing hand-made details and precision, and draws inspiration from natural motifs and symbolic narratives to give the product a meaningful identity. At the same time, it balances luxury and minimalism, resulting in a product that is both elegant and thoughtfully designed.

Inspiration & Introduction



Theme Inspiration1

The design of this leather drawstring bag is inspired by the dragonfly, symbolizing agility, lightness, and precision — qualities that resonate with boxing as a sport. Dragonflies are known for their aerodynamic wings and agile flight; similarly, boxers need speed, control, and adaptability. The geometric wing pattern laser-etched/stitched onto the leather pays homage to this inspiration.

Background & Relevance

Boxers often carry their gloves separately in plastic or ordinary gym bags that don't suit the special care gloves require. A specialized, durable, and stylish leather bag provides both functional protection and aesthetic value, making it suitable for professional athletes and enthusiasts.

Problem Statement

"How might we create a functional, durable, and visually unique bag to carry boxing gloves — while drawing from natural inspirations to enhance its identity?"

Goat Leather



Goat Leather (Moroccan Leather)

Goat leather is a popular choice in fashion and accessories, valued for its soft touch, lightweight feel, natural grain, and long-lasting durability. Its flexible yet strong structure makes it perfect for items that face regular use, while its breathability prevents odor and moisture buildup.

Why It Was Chosen:

It offers a great balance of luxury and practicality, is easy to cut and stitch for detailed designs, and its natural sheen and grain enhance the visual appeal. Over time, it develops a beautiful patina, adding character to the product.

Common Uses:

Widely used in handbags, wallets, jackets, gloves, and footwear due to its versatility and resilience.

User Research

Target Audience Definition

Primary Users: Amateur & professional boxers, boxing trainees, gym-goers involved in combat sports.

Secondary Users: Trainers, sports clubs, boxing academies (as buyers/distributors).

Demographics:

Age: 18–40 years

Gender: All

Location: Urban/metropolitan areas with access to gyms and sports clubs

Lifestyle: Physically active, style-conscious, functional product users

User Persona

Name: Rahul Verma



Age: 26

Occupation: Amateur Boxer & Fitness Trainer

Pain Points:

Carrying boxing gloves separately is messy and unhygienic
Regular gym bags don't fit gloves properly, causing damage
Wants something durable & classy, not plastic or nylon

Needs:

Proper ventilation & space for gloves
Durable material to handle sweat & weight
Unique, stylish design reflecting his sport

User Journey / Usage Scenarios

Stage	Task	User Thoughts	Emotions	Opportunities
Pre-Gym	Packs gloves into bag	"I hope they don't stink up my other stuff."	Concerned	Use breathable lining or partition
In Transit	Carries bag	"Looks cool with my outfit."	Confident	Stylish form boosts self-image
Post-Training	Packs sweaty gloves back	"Need to keep gloves separate."	Practical	Easy drawstring access for quick stowing

Observed & Unseen User Needs

Observed: Easy to carry, fits gloves snugly, durable material, simple opening system.

Unseen: Bag reflects user's identity, ventilates gloves, protects from leather degradation, has potential for personalization (e.g., name embossing).

Product Usage Context / Space

- Boxing gyms, training centers
- In transit to/from gym
- Storage at home or club locker rooms

Market & Competitive Research

Existing Products & Solutions

- Nylon sports drawstring bags (lightweight, cheap)
- Leather duffle bags (larger, heavier, multipurpose)
- Mesh ventilated glove bags



Market Analysis & Key Insights

Growing interest in combat sports among youth.

Shift towards premium sports accessories — users want to reflect personality through gear.

Sustainability & long-lasting materials (like leather) are valued in premium segments.

Current Market Trends

Product Trends: Personalization (monograms, motifs), compact utility bags, crossover of fashion & sport.

Lifestyle Trends: Fitness as a lifestyle, aesthetic-driven sports accessories.

Competitor Analysis (Benchmarking Table)

Product	Material	Target User	Unique Feature	Gap
Generic Nylon Drawstring	Nylon	Beginners	Lightweight	No protection / short lifespan
Mesh Ventilated Bags	Synthetic mesh	All levels	Breathability	Not stylish / low durability
Branded Leather Duffle	Leather	Pro athletes	Premium look	Oversized for gloves only

Gap Identified: A medium-sized, stylish, leather glove-specific bag with a unique identity is missing.

Material & Craft Exploration

Material Research & Trends

- Material Used: Genuine tanned leather — known for durability, aesthetic appeal, and natural breathability.
- Trend: Use of traditional materials in modern functional products is rising.
- Advantages: Long life, luxurious look, resistant to rough use.
- Considerations: Weight, maintenance, cost.

Craft Techniques / Manufacturing Possibilities

Machine stitching (used in current prototype) for consistent seams and strength.

Laser etching or embossing for dragonfly motif.

Potential for hand-stitch detailing for premium finishes.

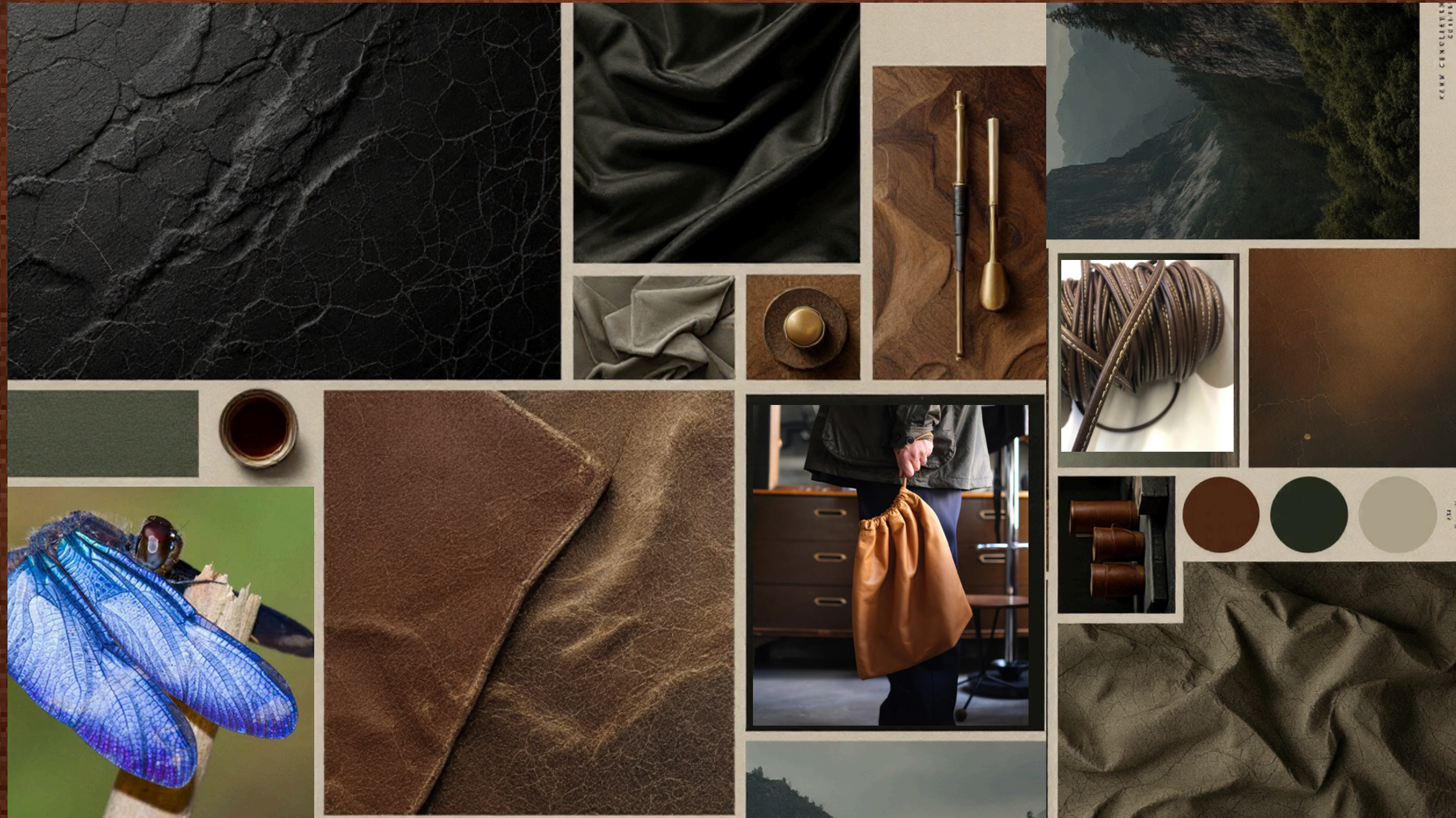
Personalization & Customization Techniques

Embossed initials or names on the leather surface.

Custom wing patterns or color variations.

Adjustable strap options for different carrying styles.

Mood Board



Product Design Principles

Functionality

- Designed to carry boxing gloves comfortably.
- Drawstring closure for quick access.
- Long straps for shoulder carry.

Aesthetic Direction

- Inspired by dragonfly wing geometry.
- Clean surface, minimal clutter, geometric linear patterns.
- Blends sportiness with elegance.

Ergonomics & Human Factors

- Handles: Dual straps for balanced weight distribution.
- Opening: Wide mouth allows gloves to fit without struggle.
- Size: Optimized for gloves, not oversized.

Design Language / CMF

- Color: Warm brown tones → organic and timeless.
- Material: Genuine leather → durability + identity.
- Finish: Smooth matte with linear etching.

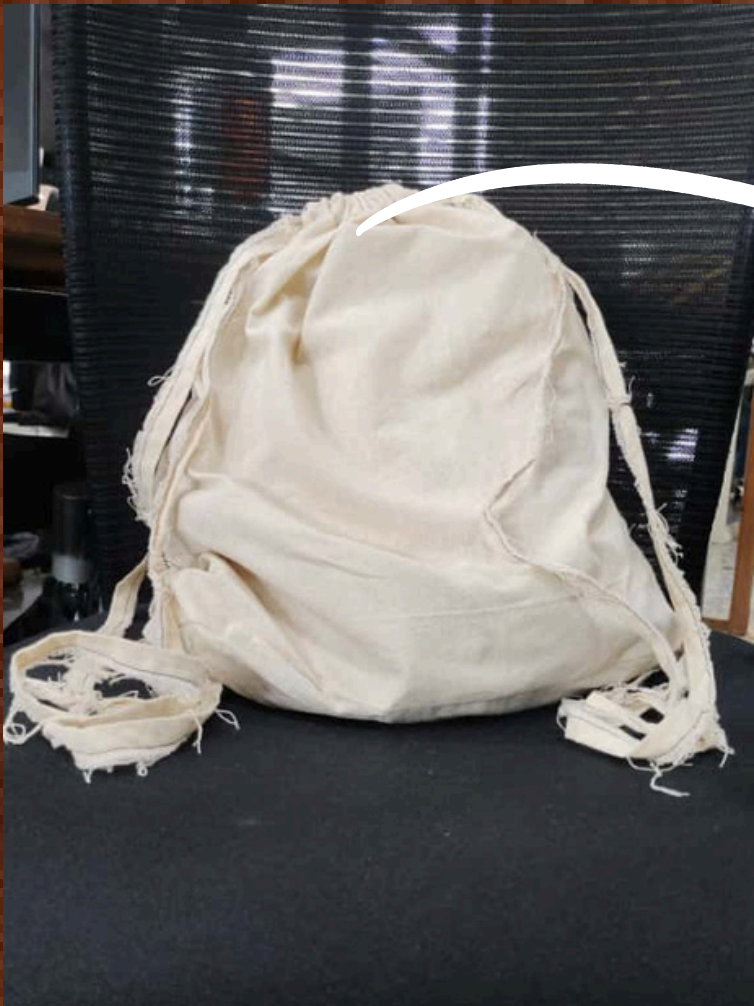
Product Development

Mockup: Muslin Cloth

Bag with open mouth



Machine-stitched muslin prototype developed and photographed.



Bag with close mouth

Product Photography



Back



Front

Conclusion / Reflection

- Successfully merged natural inspiration with sports utility.
- Identified market gap between cheap nylon bags and oversized duffles.
- Explored leather as a premium material with design identity.
- **Future scope:** Add ventilation panels, personalization options, and scalable small-batch production.

